

advantage if you have group health insurance, but many couples do not have this benefit. Those who do not must allocate a greater amount of their budget. In most cases, it will be far in excess of 5 percent.

What this means is you must reduce spending in another area of the budget to compensate. Additional expenses must be anticipated and the funds set aside regularly. Failure to do this will spoil any budget and lead to indebtedness.

One of the best ways to reduce medical expenses is to reduce the number of visits to your doctor. Perhaps the biggest problem in medicine today is that many, if not most, of the people going to doctors could have treated themselves for incidental colds, flu, or other minor illnesses. I'm not suggesting that you should not go to the doctor if you're sick, but I am suggesting that you ought to decide whether your illness is severe enough to require professional medical treatment. Practice preventive medicine. Treat your body properly with the right amount of sleep, exercise, and nutrition, and your body will usually respond with good health.

Treat your teeth wisely and your teeth will also respond with good dental health. Teach your children proper dental care, including the use of dental floss. If you do, you will find your expenses will drop significantly.

An area of real concern for Christian dentists and doctors is the number of Christian patients who don't pay their bills, either on time or ever. It's understandable that a couple can find themselves in a situation where they have medical bills they can't pay on time. What is not understandable is that they don't contact the doctor and work out a reasonable repayment plan.

There are very few doctors or dentists who would refuse treatment to anyone who was making a legitimate attempt to be honest. I have seen couples who, when they were unable to pay in cash, worked out a repayment plan that included doing services such as painting, landscaping, plumbing, whatever they were able to do to repay the fees. I know of no professionals who look down on these people for their desire